

56. Match List-I (A) with List-II (B) and select the correct answer from the codes given below the lists:

List-I (Ancient Places of U.P.)	List-II (Capital)
A. Kuru	1. Saket
B. Panchal	2. Kaushambi
C. Kosala	3. Ahichhatra
D. Vatsa	4. Indraprastha

Code:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	4	3	1	2
(c)	3	4	2	1
(d)	4	2	3	1

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The location of 16 Mahajanapadas of the 6th century B.C. are found in Buddhist text "Anguttara Nikaya" and Jain text "Bhagavati Sutra". The correctly matched list of Mahajanapadas and their Capitals is as follows:

(Mahajanapads)	(Capitals)
Kuru	- Indraprastha
Panchal	- Ahichchhatra
Koshala	- Saket
Vatsa	- Kaushambi

57. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists:

List-I (Mahajanapadas)	List-II (Capitals)
A. Matsya	1. Mathura
B. Kuru	2. Potan
C. Shurasena	3. Virat Nagar
D. Asmak	4. Indraprastha

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	4	2	1	3
(b)	3	1	4	2
(c)	3	4	1	2
(d)	2	3	4	1

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

Correct match of List-I with List-II is as follows :-

List-I (Mahajanapadas)	List-II (Capitals)
Matsya	Virat Nagar
Kuru	Indraprastha
Shurasena	Mathura
Ashmak	Potan

58. Which of the following is NOT correctly matched?

(a) Kamboj	- Rajpur/Hatak
(b) Ashmak	- Potan/Potil
(c) Shurasen	- Kaushambi
(d) Koshal	- Shravasti

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

Shurasena was an ancient Yadava ruler of Mathura. Other options are correctly matched.

59. How many Mahajanapadas were located in present day of Uttar Pradesh among the oldest sixteen Mahajanapadas of India?

(a) 06	(b) 07
(c) 08	(d) 09

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (c)

Out of 16 Mahajanapadas, 8 were present in modern Uttar Pradesh.

Kuru – Meerut, Delhi and Thaneshwar

Panchala - Bareilly, Badaun, Farrukhabad

Shurasena – Brajmandal areas

Vatsa – Prayagraj and Kaushambi

Koshal – Awadh area

Malla – Deoria, Kushinagar etc.

Kashi – Varanasi

Chedi – Eastern Bundelkhand area

60. Which one of the following statements is not true about Shreni System of Ancient India?

(a) Shreni was the organisation of traders and artisans.
(b) Quality and the price of the produced goods was determined by the concerned Shreni.
(c) Shreni used to control the conduct of its members.
(d) Shreni system was prevalent only in Northern India.

[R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre)-2018]

Ans. (d)

Shreni system of ancient India was basically the organisation of traders and artisans which used to not just control the quality and prices of the produced goods but also the conduct of its members. This system was prevalent in Northern India as well as southern India.

Greek Invasion

*In the 6th century BC, there was an ambitious man named Kurush or Sairus II (558-529 BC) who established the **Achae-menid Empire** in central Iran. Behistun, Persepolis and Naqsh-e- Rostam inscriptions are from Darius I (522-486 BC) reign. These inscriptions provide important information about India-Persia relations. The 23 provinces in the empire

of Darius-I have been mentioned in **Behistun inscription**.

*Herodotus described that India was the twentieth province of Darius's empire. *Ctesias was the State Doctor (Rajya Vaidya) of Artaxerxes II. A new script named '**Kharoshti**' originated out of the Iranian Aramaic script that evolved in Northwestern India as a result of the Persian relations. There were eight inheritors of Mahapadamananda found in Puranas and Buddhist texts. ***Dhanananda** was the last ruler of this dynasty who was also the contemporary of **Alexander**. Greek writers referred him as **Agrammese**. Xenophon describes him as a wealthy person. Bhaddasala was his commander.

*After demolishing the **Achaemenid Empire** in **326 BC**, Alexander started his Indian campaign with a huge army. After two years, he returned to Greece from Paatal in **325 BC**.

***Ashvaka** was a frontier republic at the time of the invasion of Alexander, the capital of which was Massaga. According to Greek writers, the women had taken up arms against Alexander when a large number of men were killed in the war against him. In the descriptions, it is found that Alexander killed all the women of this town. *The realm of **Puru (Porus)** was located between Jhelum and Chenab River. Alexander defeated him on the bank of Jhelum river, but he was impressed by his courage and became his friend and returned his state and also gifted him some more areas.

1. Which one of the following dynasties was ruling over North India at the time of Alexander's invasion?

- (a) Nanda (b) Maurya
(c) Sunga (d) Kanva

I.A.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

There were eight inheritors of Mahapadmananda found in Puranas and Buddhist texts. Dhanananda was the last ruler of this dynasty who was also a contemporary of Alexander. Greek writers referred him as Agrammese. Xenophon describes him as a wealthy person. Bhaddasala was his commander.

2. Which one of the following rulers of Magadha was the contemporary of Alexander, the Great ?

- (a) Mahapadmananda (b) Dhanananda
(c) Sukalpa (d) Chandragupta Maurya

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

3. Consider the following statements:

Assertion (A) : After campaigning for nearly two years, Alexander, the Great, left India in 325 B.C.

Reason (R) : He was defeated by Chandra Gupta Maurya.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

After demolishing the Achaemenid empire in 326 BC, Alexander started his Indian campaign with a huge army. After two years, he returned to Greece from Paatal in 325 BC. But he was not defeated by Chandragupta Maurya. Thus, Assertion (A) is true, but Reason (R) is false.

4. The women of which Indian republic or kingdom had taken up arms against Alexander after a large number of its soldiers had been killed or wounded in the battlefield ?

- (a) Abhisara (b) Glausai
(c) Katha (d) Massaga

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (d)

Ashvaka was a frontier republic at the time of the invasion of Alexander, whose capital was Massaga. According to Greek writers, the women had taken up arms against Alexander when a large number of men were killed in the war against him. This description describes that Alexander had killed all the women of this town.

5. Alexander's success in India was due to the following :

1. There was no central power in India at that time
2. He had a superior army
3. He was helped by the traitorous Indian rulers
4. He was a good administrator

Select the correct answer from the following code :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) All the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

The first three reasons given behind the success of Alexander in India are correct. Dr. Hemachandra Rai Chaudhary mentioned 28 independent powers of that time. It means there was no central authority in India at that time. Undoubtedly his (Alexander's) army was superior. Many Indian traitor kings like Ambhi supported him. Being good administrator was not a reason behind his victory over India. Thus, option (b) is the correct answer.